

Psalms 63

Early Will I Seek Thee

Early will I seek thee

KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 *O God, thou art my God; early will I seek thee: my soul thirsteth for thee, my flesh longeth for thee in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is;*
- 2 *To see thy power and thy glory, so as I have seen thee in the sanctuary.*
- 3 *Because thy lovingkindness is better than life, my lips shall praise thee.*
- 4 *Thus will I bless thee while I live: I will lift up my hands in thy name.*
- 5 *My soul shall be satisfied as with marrow and fatness; and my mouth shall praise thee with joyful lips:*
- 6 *When I remember thee upon my bed, and meditate on thee in the night watches.*
- 7 *Because thou hast been my help, therefore in the shadow of thy wings will I rejoice.*
- 8 *My soul followeth hard after thee: thy right hand upholdeth me.*
- 9 *But those that seek my soul, to destroy it, shall go into the lower parts of the earth.*
- 10 *They shall fall by the sword: they shall be a portion for foxes.*
- 11 *But the king shall rejoice in God; every one that sweareth by him shall glory: but the mouth of them that speak lies shall be stopped.*

2 · CONTEXT

Superscription places David "in the wilderness of Judah," likely fleeing Saul or Absalom, physically thirsty in a literal dry and barren land. Henry notes how physical thirst becomes the doorway to spiritual longing—desire for God expressed in bodily terms. MacArthur-style notes point to the psalm's structure moving from longing (1–2), to satisfaction remembered (3–5), to nighttime meditation (6–8), to confidence over enemies (9–11).

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-2

"O God, thou art my God; early will I seek thee: my soul thirsteth for thee... in a dry and thirsty land, where no water is." Physical deprivation in the wilderness intensifies, rather than dampens, spiritual desire—he seeks God's power and glory as once seen in the sanctuary.

Verse 3-5

"Because thy lovingkindness is better than life, my lips shall praise thee... my soul shall be satisfied as with marrow and fatness." Even lacking literal water, he is more filled by God's lovingkindness than by any physical provision, praising with lifted hands.

Verse 6-8

Meditation continues into sleeplessness: "When I remember thee upon my bed, I meditate on thee in the night watches... My soul followeth hard after thee: thy right hand upholdeth me." Longing does not fade in darkness but turns to sustained, pursuing meditation.

Verse 9-11

Enemies "that seek my soul to destroy it" will fall by the sword and become "a portion for foxes," while the king will rejoice in God and every true worshiper will glory, but "the mouth of them that speak lies shall be stopped." Confidence in vindication closes the psalm.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Genuine thirst for God is not incompatible with literal scarcity—wilderness deprivation can become the very occasion for the deepest satisfaction, praise, and pursuing meditation, because God's lovingkindness outweighs life itself.

Application for life today.

In a literal or figurative "dry and thirsty land," let physical longing point you toward greater spiritual thirst rather than only complaint. Practice remembering God specifically "upon my bed" and in "night watches" when sleep is elusive. Let satisfaction in

God's lovingkindness, not changed circumstances, be the goal you actually seek "early."

5 · REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What "dry and thirsty land" are you in right now, and how might it become an occasion to seek God "early"?

2. How can nighttime restlessness become meditation on God rather than only anxiety, as in verses 6–8?

3. In what specific way is God's "lovingkindness" currently "better than life" for you?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).